

Lesson 2: Territorial Tactics

Overview

Students investigate the different ways that the Oregon Territorial Government used strategies to foster relationships with Indigenous Peoples. Students become familiar with different territorial tactics used to create or calm conflict with Indigenous Peoples to facilitate settler colonialism.

Estimated Delivery Time

Two 40- to 60-minute sessions

Essential Questions (EQs)

What is the history of the Uilla Indian Agency? *Where* is the setting? *Who* are the main characters? *What* do they do together? *When* did these events happen?

How did archaeologists confirm the location of Fort Henrietta?

Supporting Questions

What is an “Indian Agency”? Why did the Oregon Territory establish one?

What is a fort? Why build forts? Who builds forts?

Success Criteria

I am learning...

...the history and purpose of the Uilla Indian Agency.

...the history of Fort Henrietta.

I will know I am successful when...

...I can connect different primary sources from the Indian Agency period to each other and use the information from these sources to explain what life might have been like there.

...I can explain how archaeologists learned about and relocated Fort Henrietta.

Ičičkīin Sínwit [Sahaptian Vocabulary]

[Link to interactive glossary.](#)

Lesson Vocabulary

[Link to interactive glossary.](#)

Background Information for Educators

Review background information prior to teaching the lesson.

- > Read [this excerpt about the Utiilla Indian Agency](#) from *The Echo Story* compiled by Dr. John Woodward.
- > Watch the following videos from the Confluence Project Library to better understand tribal perspectives on the content of this lesson:
[Leah Conner describing an Encounter with the Militia at the Dalles](#)
[Bobbie Conner discussing American Policies of “Divide and Conquer”](#)
- > Read [this History Link Article](#) about the Oregon Mounted Volunteers and the context of the Plateau War.

Materials Needed

Gather the following materials:

- > The whole class Know Wonder Learn (KWL) graphic organizer for ongoing assessment
- > [Slide deck with embedded video](#) (both sessions are combined in this deck).
There is additional information in the “notes” section on the slideshows that may help you facilitate the lessons. There are also various levels of detail that you can present depending on how in-depth you want to make your class discussion.
- > **For Session 1:**
 - “Tule Place Reflection Booklet” pages 8-9
 - Item Sets from the Teaching Trunk labeled for Lesson 2
- > **For Session 2:** “Tule Place Reflection Booklet” page 10

Step-by-Step Instructions

Part One: Utila Indian Agency [Session 1: 40-60 minutes]

1. Introduce Indian Agencies as a Territorial Tactic [5-10 minutes]

- Revisit KWL with attention to what has been learned most recently and what students are still wondering
- Using the slide deck - Lead a brief class conversation surrounding these two questions:
 - What is an “Indian Agency”?
 - Why did the Oregon Territory establish one?

This is an excellent opportunity to emphasize vocabulary building around the lesson name – “Territorial Tactics”

Talking Point:

Today we will be answering the question, “What is the history of the Utila Indian Agency?” To understand this story, we will need to answer who, what, when, where, and why questions: Who are the main characters? What do they do together? When did these events happen? Where is the setting? Why did these events come to pass?

2. Jigsaw Delivery of Primary Sources – Utila Indian Agency [20 minutes]

- Divide students into pairs. Carefully consider your students’ skillsets and choose your pairs wisely to ensure the success of this activity. For example, it may be beneficial to assign the diary entries and Indian agent letters to students with higher reading comprehension skills (or at least one per pair) and assign the Sahaptian sentence interpretation, which requires internet access, to students who focus effectively and are reliable with semi-independent technology use.
- **Talking Point:** *In this activity, you will practice thinking like an archaeologist. You will analyze different kinds of primary sources which show many different perspectives about the Utila Indian Agency.*

- Each pair will analyze either textual primary sources or learn from belongings or beings as primary sources:
 - Set A – Tribal Elder’s Story
 - Set B – Tule & Dogbane samples on information sheet
 - Set C – Excerpt of J. L. Johnson’s August 5, 1851, diary entry
 - Set D – Calico fabric with bone and ceramic buttons
 - Set E – Wood samples with information sheets
 - Set F – Abridged letter from Indian Agent, Elias Wampole
 - Set G – Various sizes of cut nails and nail sizing chart
 - Set H – Ceramic ink well fragments and reassembly instructions
 - Set I – Excerpt of V. Pringle’s September 25, 1853, diary entry
 - Set J – Foodstuff sample (coffee, flour, sugar)
 - Set K – Reproduction clay pipe (like those sold at the agency)
 - Set L – Newspaper report of wholesale prices
 - Set M – Can artifact images and manufacturing timeline
 - Set N – Sahaptian sentence (NEED computer/internet access)

NOTE: There are enough sets included in the Teaching Trunk for 14 pairs of students (total class size of 28). If you have a larger class size you can make copies of any of the textual sets [A, C, F, I, L, M, or N] and have multiple pairs of students work on the same set. If you have a class smaller than 28 students, you can either have students work individually and include all the item sets, *or* leave out sets L, M, and N. Removing sets other than these will diminish students’ ability to synthesize the “big picture” of what life was like at the Indian Agency.

3. Jigsaw Debrief

- Use slides 5-17 as a guide to lead a class discussion making connections between historical documents and artifacts to tell the story of the Uilla Indian Agency (essential question). Use “Stand Up/Sit Down” as an indicator of student engagement with the debrief material. Recommended “stand up if...” topics include:
 - ... Indigenous Peoples perspectives [A, B, C, N]
 - ... overland migrant perspectives [C, I]
 - ... territorial government perspectives [C, F]

- ... building materials [A, B, C, E, F, G, I, L]
 - ... something to do with clothing [C, D, L]
 - ... food items [C, I, J, L, M]
 - ... something to do with tobacco [C, K, L]
 - ... “Dr. Dart” [C, F]
 - ... 10d (10 penny) nails [F, G]
 - ... something to do with writing [F, H, L]
 - ... trade, commerce, or planning [C, F, I, L, N]
 - ... Elias Wampole [F, I]
- When students stand up, have them share with the class any information about the topic they learned about from their primary sources. NOTE: The above-mentioned associations are not exhaustive, feel free to let your students make an argument for WHY they think that their source fits into the topic/group that you’ve prompted them on.

4. Session 1 Closure/Wrap-up

- As students are sharing and contextualizing the items, use the classroom KWL graphic organizer to write down newly acquired “learnings” from this activity. You can use additional time to have students record what they’ve learned on their own KWL page 3 within their Tule Place Teachings Reflection Booklet

Part Two: Fort Henrietta [Session 2: 40-60 minutes]

5. Introduce Forts as a Territorial Tactic

- Revisit whole-class KWL graphic organizer to refresh learning about the Uilla Indian Agency and transition into the Fort
- Using the slide deck, lead students in a conversation with the following guiding questions:
 - What is a fort?
 - Who builds forts?
 - Why build a fort?

This is an excellent opportunity to emphasize vocabulary building around the lesson name – “Territorial Tactics”

6. Learn about Fort Henrietta from a Secondary Source

- Prepare students to use page 10 of their Reflection Booklet to help focus their attention on the content of the video embedded on slide 22.
- Play the video which talks about the primary sources that archaeologists and historians used to learn about Fort Henrietta.

7. Thinking like an archaeologist

Talking Point:

Based on all the information we just learned from this secondary source (the video), we are going to answer the question, “How did archaeologists confirm the location of Fort Henrietta?”

- Present the following slides to show different lines of evidence that archaeologists found at the dig site and ask students to contextualize how these items connect to the narrative of the fort as presented in the video. Refer to the “speaker notes” within the slide deck for guidance on each piece of evidence.
- On page 10 of their Reflection Booklet, students are prompted to quickly sketch some of these pieces of evidence or artifacts, be sure to remind them and provide enough time for this.

8. Session 2 closure/wrap-up

- Revisit the essential question: How did archaeologists confirm the location of Fort Henrietta?
- Revisit the whole-class KWL graphic organizer and student pages 1-3 in the Tule Place Reflection Booklet and record new information learned about Fort Henreitta and/or archaeology. You can use additional time to allow students to record what they’ve learned in their own KWL pages within their Tule Place Reflection Booklet.

Assessment

Lesson can be assessed for the following:

- > Assess students' understandings of concepts verbally shared during jigsaw activity debrief and based on the notes they wrote on pages 8-9 of the Reflection Booklet
- > Student participation and comments during the "Stand Up/Sit Down" jigsaw debrief.
- > Know Wonder Learn student page 3 in the Echoes of the Past Reflection Booklet can be used to evaluate the new information students have recorded in the "learn" column.

Support for All Students

Student supports include:

- > There are two versions of all the sets with diary entries or letters included in the Primary Source Activity (jigsaw). As with the Reflection Booklet, the longer and more complex versions of the excerpts are designated by the rock icon in the upper right corner and the more streamlined versions are designated by the river icon in the upper right corner.
- > A scaffolded version of the booklet is available for students who would benefit from more structured guidance. This version is designated by the river icon on the cover page.
- > You can turn on closed captions for any of the videos to help students follow along. Transcripts are also available.

Extensions

Student extensions include:

- > Consider including the vocabulary from this lesson in other spelling or language practice by using the words in your regular spelling lessons or by having students make flashcards to practice acquiring new vocabulary.
- > If you find that your students are not typically successful with a jigsaw method of delivery, consider setting up each of the sets as a station in your

classroom and have pairs of students rotate through all of them. The independent station method of delivery allows all students to personally engage with all the sources of information before being asked to consider the connections among sets and synthesize ideas.

- > To apply this content to grade 6 and above, teachers may emphasize more of the governmental aspects of territorial tactics by exploring treaty negotiations, tribal sovereignty, and nation-to-nation relations.
 - What are the “territorial tactics” of an Indian Agency? Why did territorial governments create them and have Indian Agents?
 - What are the “territorial tactics” of a fort? How is military action different from the strategy of an Indian Agency?

Oregon Grade 4 Social Science Standards (2024)

- 4.G.GR.2** On political and physical maps of North America, locate significant sites in the United States, Mexico, Canada, Oregon, Nevada, Alaska, Hawai`i, Washington, Idaho, and California.
- 4.G.MM.4** Compare and contrast varying patterns of exploration and settlement in the Pacific Northwest over time, considering how physical features and the availability of natural resources affected exploration and settlement patterns, including the development of major urban/suburban areas, industries, or trade.
- 4.G.HI.6** Assess how physical geography and changing environmental factors affect land use and shape the cultural characteristics of a society.
- 4.E.ES.1** Examine the consequences of power and privilege on issues associated with poverty, income, and wealth accumulation.
- 4.E.MI.5** Investigate the relationship between the supply and demand of goods produced in Oregon.
- 4.E.IC.8** Analyze different buying choices and opportunity costs
- 4.E.ST.10** Explain how trade leads to increasing economic interdependence.
- 4.H.CH.2** Investigate the role of “Manifest Destiny” and racial prejudice in shaping Oregon’s transition from “Oregon Country” to statehood. Include the legal, political, and cultural factors causing marginalization and attempts to promote inclusivity.

- 4.H.CH.1** Identify and examine the Indigenous sovereign people of Oregon prior to and during waves of exploration and settlement from Europe and the United States.
- 4.H.CC.3** Identify examples of Indigenous resistance to the expansion of non-Indigenous settlers into Oregon lands in the causes and results of the battles and wars in Oregon Territory and 19th century Oregon.
- 4.H.CE.4** Give examples of how changes in Oregon's agricultural, industrial, political, and business development over time affect people of the state including traditionally underrepresented groups.
- 4.H.CP.6** Identify the history, religion, languages, and cultural practices of the Indigenous Tribes of Oregon and examples of resistance and resilience to immigration and settlement by the United States.
- 4.H.CP.8** Identify various conflicts within Oregon, including acts of displacement, cultural and linguistic loss, violence, economic competition, political disagreements, boundary disputes, and cultural disparities across different geographical regions and demographic groups.

Oregon Grade 4 English Language Arts Standards (2026)

- 4.RF.4** Read grade-level text with fluency (accuracy, rate, prosody) to support comprehension.
- 4.RF.4a** Read text with purpose and understanding.
- 4.RF.4c** Use context to confirm or self-correct word recognition and understanding, rereading as necessary.
- 4.RI.1** Cite evidence from the text when explaining what the text says explicitly and when drawing inferences from the text.
- 4.RI.2** Analyze how the central ideas are reflected in a text and cite relevant implicit and explicit evidence from the text; summarize the text.
- 4.RI.3** Explain the individuals, events, procedures, ideas, or concepts in a historical, scientific, or technical text, including what happened and why, based on specific information in the text.
- 4.RI.6** Compare and contrast a firsthand and secondhand account of the same event or topic; describe the differences in focus and the information provided.

- 4.W.2e** Use precise language and domain-specific vocabulary to inform about or explain the topic.
- 4.SL.1** Engage effectively in a range of collaborative discussions with diverse partners on grade 4 topics and texts, building on others' ideas and expressing personal ideas clearly.
- 4.SL.1b** Follow agreed-upon rules for discussions and carry out assigned roles.
- 4.SL.1d** Review the key ideas expressed and explain personal ideas and understanding in light of the discussion.